WAKE TECH COMMUNITY COLLEGE

Information Technology Division · Computer Prog & Info Science

Computing Fundamentals I

CSC-120

Fall 2026 Section 0002 4 Credit(s) 08/17/2026 to 12/16/2026 Delivery Method: Online
Modified 08/15/2026

How & When our Course Meets

Course Format: 16 Weeks AsynchronousOnline Course

Meeting Days / Times / Location:

Students can contact me via MS/TEAM for help if there is any lab assignment problems:

I will be in my office:

(1) Tuesday: 12:00 P.M. ~ 04:00 P.M.

(2) Wednesday: 12:00 P.M. ~ 04:00 P.M.

(3) Thursday: 12:00 P.M. ~ 04:00 P.M.

*** Others by appointments 24 hours ahead ***

Schedule Adjustment and Withdrawals

Each semester, you have a window of opportunity to make changes to your course schedule or withdraw. The timing of when you withdraw impacts how much, if any, of your tuition may be refunded and may also impact your financial aid.

To view the withdrawal deadlines, please visit Wake Tech's Calendar (https://www.waketech.edu/student-services/registration-student-records).
To view the comprehensive withdrawal policy, visit Withdrawal Policy (https://www.waketech.edu/catalog/academic-information)
To contact financial aid, visit Financial Aid (https://www.waketech.edu/%EF%AC%81nancial-aid)

Meet Your Instructor

Instructor: Mr. Chenpi, Peter, Chen
Email: cpchen@waketech.edu
Work Phone: (919) 866-5360
Office Location: WTCC Northern Campus, Building B, NB340 or online via MS Teams
Office Hours:

Tuesday: 12:00 P.M. ~ 04:00 P.M.
Wednesday: 12:00 P.M. ~ 04:00 P.M.
Thursday: 12:00 P.M. ~ 04:00 P.M.

What This Course Is About

This course provides the essential foundation for the discipline of computing and a program of study in computer science, including the role of the professional. Topics include algorithm design, data abstraction, searching and sorting algorithms, and procedural programming techniques. Upon completion, students should be able to solve problems, develop algorithms, specify data types, perform sorts and searches, and use an operating system.

Requisites

Prerequisite (must be completed before taking the course).

State Prerequisites - Take One Set:

- Set 1: DMA-010, DMA-020, DMA-030, DMA-040, and DMA-050
- Set 2: DMA-010, DMA-020 DMA-030 and DMA-045
- Set 3: DMA-025, DMA-040 and DMA-050
- Set 4: DMA-025 and DMA-045
- Set 5: MAT-121
- Set 6: MAT-171
- Set 7: MAT-003
- Set 8: BSP-4003

Why this Course is Relevant to You

Welcome to CSC 120: Computing Fundamentals I! This course is your gateway to understanding the foundational principles of computer programming and computational thinking. These skills are highly sought after in today's technology-driven world and will prepare you for future coursework, internships,a nd careers in fields ranging from software development to data science. By learning to write and debug code, solve problems systematically, and think like a computer scientist, you'll gain tools that are applicable across many industries and academic disciplines. Whether your goal is to create applications, analyze data, or simply enhance your problem-solving skills, this course is a vital first step on your journey.

What You'll Learn: Student Learning Outcomes

Upon completion of this course, you will be able to:

- CLO 1: Learn a pseudocode language
- CLO 2: Recognize flowchart and pseudocode
- CLO 3: Use selection control structures, logical operators, arrays, functions
- CLO 4: Use count controlled for loop and event controlled while loop
- CLO 5: Use hypotheses and tests in trouble shooting and debug programs
- CLO 6: Compute algorithm efficiency, use search algorithm, sort algorithm

What You'll Need: Textbook & Materials

Eagle Advantage is Wake Tech's textbook program for students in degree programs, excluding Career & College Promise (CCP) and Cooperative Innovative High School (Early College) students. The program ensures all required printed and digital textbooks are bundled and ready for pickup or delivery on or before the first day of class - saving you time and money and ensuring you're ready to learn on Day One.

If you are opted-in to Eagle Advantage, visit the "Course Materials-BibliU" link in Blackboard for more information about the textbook details for your course. You can also find out more information by visiting FAQs and Troubleshooting BibliU (https://support.bibliu.com/hc/en-us/sections/360004011038--FAQs-and-Troubleshootin)

If you opted-out of Eagle Advantage, you are responsible for purchasing any of the required texts/materials for this course. For more information about Eagle Advantage, contact our Bookstore (https://www.waketechcampusstore.com/SelectTermDept)

CSC 120 Computing Fundamentals I

Author: Frank Vahid, Roman Lysecky
Publisher: zybooks.com
Edition: Digital Interactive Textbook
Year: 2026

Access to the Digital Interactive Textbook is from a link in our course's Blackboard shell which will be available once the course semester begins, and our Blackboard course shell opens. Students enrolled in Wake Tech's Eagle Advantage program will receive their individual access code via the BibliU link in Blackboard and then will click a link in our Blackboard course shell and provide that access code to gain access to the textbook. Students not enrolled in Wake Tech's Eagle Advantage program can click on a link in our Blackboard course shell and pay for the textbook subscription by credit card. Each course section has its own clone of the Digital Interactive Textbook with a unique ISBN number an zyBook code, and these are unique for each semester the course is offered.

✓ How Your Work will be Evaluated: Grading Information

Breakdown

Grading Scale

This course uses a 10-point grading scale. The final weighted numeric grade average is rounded to the nearest whole number to compute the course letter grade.

Course Grade	Criteria
A	90 % and up
B	80% - 89%
C	70% - 79%
D	60% - 69%
F	less than 60%

Criteria

Assignments, Exams, Activities

Category	Weight
Participation	10%
Challenge	15%
Lab Assignments	25%
Quizzes	10%
Project	10%
Midterm Exam	15%
Final Exam	15%

How You'll Proceed Through the Course: Course Calendar

Please follow the course schedule below.

When	Topic	Notes

When	Topic	Notes
Lesson 01	Introduction to Computing Fundamentals	
Lesson 02	Variables + Expressions	
Lesson 03	Branches + Decisions	
Lesson 04	Loops, Basic	
Lesson 05	Loops: Nested + Patterns	
Lesson 06	Arrays	
Lesson 07	Midterm Review + EXAM	
Lesson 08	Functions, Basic	
Lesson 09	Functions, Advanced	
Lesson 10	Software Topics	
Lesson 11	Program Debugging	
Lesson 12	Algorithms, Basics + Searching	
Lesson 13	Algorithms, Sorting	
Lesson 14	Project	
Lesson 15	Project (continuation)	
Lesson 16	Final EXAM + Wrap Up	

✳ How I Will Help You Succeed: Instructor Policies & Procedures

How to Succeed in This Class

Students who come to each lesson prepared to learn, participate in activities, complete assignments, and have good study habits will succeed in this course. Should you have any concerns about your success in this course, please contact me as soon as possible.

Communication Expectations

When emailing or chatting via MS/TEAM , please be sure to include your course and section number. You can also communicate with me in-person during office/student hours. Please use your provided my.waketech.edu e-mail account for all school-related correspondence. Due to security concerns, any

emails from a personal account may not be delivered successfully.
***Emailor MS/TEAM response time: During the week, I will reply to emails within 24 hours. If I do not respond within 24 hours, please contact me again to follow up. On the weekends, my responses may be delayed.*

Attendance

Attendance for this class will be evaluated through the submission of assignments. A required weekly assignment not submitted will count as an absence in the class for that week.

Attendance is key for your courses here at Wake Tech! We expect you to be in attendance for at least 90 percent of all scheduled class meetings. If you miss more than 10% of scheduled classes/activities, you may be withdrawn from the course. Additionally, if you are not present for 2 consecutive weeks of class, you may be withdrawn by the instructor.

Attendance is taken once per week after the weekly lesson ends. Students who have submitted at least some assignment in either Blackboard and/or the class zyBook will be marked present. Students who have not submitted work in either Blackboard or the class zybook will be marked absent.

How the Department Will Help You Succeed: Department Policies & Procedures

Tutoring and Learning Center

The Tutoring and Learning Center (TLC) offers Wake Tech students free tutoring and learning support for their classes. The mission of the TLC is to help students understand what they are learning in class, develop the skills they need to be successful in college and the workplace, and empower them to be independent learners.

Visit the TLC at Tutoring and Learning Center Site (https://www.waketech.edu/student-services/tutoring-learning-center)

Information & Digital Technology Care Team

The IT Care Team provides specialized advising and coaching support for University Transfer students interested in IT and Associate in Applied Science students enrolled in Information Technology programs.

Visit the IT Care Team website at IT Care Team Site (https://www.waketech.edu/student-services/advising/information-technology)

How the Division Will Help You Succeed: Division Policies & Procedures

Process for Expressing Concerns about the Course

1. Please discuss concerns with your instructor first.
2. If your concerns are not resolved, you may contact the Department Head or Program Director of the department.

General Division Questions

For general questions regarding the Information Technology Division or assistance with program resources, students may contact Associate Dean Emmie Mercer at ermercer1@waketech.edu for guidance or referral to the appropriate department.

Information Technology Technical Standards

This page outlines the technical standards and essential skills expected of students in Information Technology programs. Review this page for descriptions of the critical-thinking, communication, interpersonal, behavioral, and technical abilities needed to complete coursework and perform effectively in professional IT environments: IT Technical Standards (https://www.waketech.edu/about-wake-tech/divisions/information-technology/technical-standards)

🏛 How the College Will Help You Succeed: Wake Tech Services, Policies and Procedures

Wake Tech is committed to supporting you by providing the resources needed to succeed. This is a brief overview of support available at the College. You can always contact me to help you make the right connection with a college resource. We are here to help!

Student Support

As a Wake Tech student, you have free access to non-academic and academic resources to help you with a range of challenges. These resources include academic services, such as advising, tutoring and academic coaching to help you understand your career and academic pathway, Disability Support Services, Tutoring and Learning Centers, Career Services, and Library Services. The college also offers assistance with basic life needs through the Care Center. These services include mental health resources, emergency financial assistance, safe housing, transportation, and technology. If you find yourself in need, you can reach out to any faculty member or visit this website Student Support (https://www.waketech.edu/studentsupport) to learn more about the help that we can provide.

Student Activities

Wake Tech is continually developing new ways for you to get involved with the College! For information about the Student Centers, Student Government Association, Clubs and Organizations, Athletics, and more, please visit the College Catalog (https://www.waketech.edu/catalog/student-services-and-activities).

Technical Support

Wake Tech has several technology platforms to help you succeed. You may find that technical questions come up regarding your use of technology and Wake Tech is here to help. For technical support, including Blackboard, WTCC email, MS Teams, and Self Service visit the IT Helpdesk page (https://www.waketech.edu/help-center/its/topics).

Student Code of Conduct, Rights, and Responsibilities

You may have questions about your rights and responsibilities as a student. Wake Tech has a range of policies to address such concerns. For information about the Academic Integrity Policy, Complaints, Title IX Policy, Student Appeals, and more, please visit the College Catalog (https://www.waketech.edu/catalog/student-code-conduct-rights-and-responsibilities).

Academic Policies

There are several Wake Tech policies related to academics that you might need to reference in order to succeed in your classes. If you have questions about the Attendance Policy, Student Email Policy, Absences for Religious Observances, Withdrawal Policies, Grades, and more, please visit the College Catalog (https://www.waketech.edu/catalog/academic-information).

Student Information Privacy

Wake Tech is committed to protecting your privacy. The Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA) is a federal law enacted in 1974 that protects the privacy of student education records. To find out more about College policies and procedures that support your privacy, please visit the College Catalog (https://www.waketech.edu/catalog/registration-and-student-records).

Campus Policies

There are several Wake Tech policies related to campus procedures that you might need to reference to feel comfortable on campus. For information about College Police and Safety, the Acceptable Use of College Resources Policy, (Student Dress, Pets, Visitors and Children on Campus, and more, please visit the College Catalog (https://www.waketech.edu/catalog/campus-policies-and-procedures).

Registration & Student Records

For information about the Class Schedules, Registration Dates, Transcript Requests, Transfer Credits, Program of Study Changes, and more, please visit the College Catalog (https://www.waketech.edu/catalog/registration-and-student-records).

Financial Aid

Wake Tech is here to answer your financial aid questions. For information about Enrollment Requirements, Grants, Loans, Scholarships, and more, please visit the College Catalog (https://www.waketech.edu/catalog/financial-aid).

Inclement Weather/Wake Tech WARN

North Carolina can have some unpredictable weather. For up-to-date information about Emergency Closings, please sign up for the College alert system, Wake Tech WARN (https://www.waketech.edu/about-wake-tech/administrative-offices/campus-police/waketech-warn). For more information about the inclement weather policy, please visit the College Catalog (https://www.waketech.edu/catalog/campus-policies-and-procedures).

Additional Items

Late Work Policy

Assignments are expected to be submitted by the assigned due date and time posted in Blackboard. Students are encouraged to work ahead in the course materials (as lessons open) to allow greater flexibility in managing their time.

The cut-off date for late work is **December 8, 2026**. No late work will not be accepted after that date. Before the cut-off date, assignments in the Participation, Challenge, Lab Assignment, and Project categories may be submitted up to two days late with a 20% penalty, resulting in a maximum possible grade of 80%, or up to one week late with a 35% penalty, resulting in a maximum grade of 65%. During the late period, the zyBook and Blackboard will continue to show the work as late, but I will manually grade after the work is completed, and the Late Assignment Grading Request is submitted. No late work is accepted for Quizzes, the Midterm Exam, or the Final Exam.

As I do not receive notification that late work was submitted for Blackboard Discussion Forums, or any work done late in the zyBook, in order to submit work for late grading, students must first complete the assignment and then submit the Late Assignment Grading Request to let me now that the late work is ready for grading. The Late Assignment Grading Request must be submitted when the late work is ready for grading and notifies me that you have completed the late work. The Late Assignment Request is available in the Course Resource section of Blackboard. Students can submit Late Assignment Grading Request multiple times during the semester.

Quizzes and Exam:

- Quizzes will not be accepted after the due date/time, as they will automatically close in Blackboard.
- Exams must be completed and submitted on the assigned date/time; otherwise, a grade of zero will be assigned. Any exception to this policy must be the result of a documented emergency or prior arrangement with the instructor.
- ANY MAKEUP EXAMS must be taken prior to the scheduled exam date. This must be pre-arranged with the instructor. Last-minute arrangements are not acceptable.

Exceptions are made to this policy for cases covered by Title IX or documented medical emergencies for a student or their immediate family member, such as hospitalization. If you experience such circumstances, please contact the instructor as soon as possible and provide documentation (such as a doctor's note on medical letterhead) so appropriate adjustments can be made.